# Religion and Faith

The religious system implements an attribute of Faith which can be assigned to PCs and NPCs within the game system.

The classification of faiths is based on religious orders and their derived sects. Further research required to make available faiths more accurate to the historical time period

Faith A (Christianity)
- Faith A1 (Roman Catholicism)
- Faith A2 (Anglo-Saxon/Pagan Christianity)

Faith B (Celtic)
- Faith B1 (Scottish)
- Faith B2 (Irish)

or

Faith A (Christianity)
- Fath A1 (Roman Catholic)
- Faith A2 (Heretical)
    - Examples could be that of the iron nails or any other doctrine that deviates from the church

To test the functionalities of the religion system a test account `faithTest` has been created. This account has been assigned to the newly created player character `Joann Stratford`, an English Archbishop.

<u>Heresy</u>
Heresy is defined as deviation from accepted religious doctrine or practice. Within the game this would entail characters in the game performing actions which violate rules of the church, some of these could be npc actions which can be influenced through other in-game factors. Heresy could also be performed by player characters both within the clergy and outside of it.

The simplest way that the clergy can deal with occurrences of heresy is through excommunication and anathemas.

Excommunication

Certain actions can get a player excommunicated. The penalties which would apply to an outlaw are applied to excommunicated players. If a player would die while excommunicated their overlord may seize estates which could mean a total reset for the affected player.

An excommunicated character is also considered to have a soul at risk of going to hell which could be relevant.

Reasons for a player to be excommunicated

- Pillaging a fief held by the church.
    - This would require a functionality to flag which fiefs the church control. This could be either a flag in the csv file / database stating that a fief is church owned or there could be a check against overlords.
- Killing a bishop.
- Annoying an overlord on good terms with the pope.

Only a pope may remove the excommunication status from a character.

To Do

- The current set up for the csv file does not initially support the addition of more objects in a clean way. Adding both the Religion and Sect game object types will require some set up in the server files due to the method in which the csv is imported.